

Lessons:

1. The citizens should **remind the rulers of their mistakes** in a civil manner as rulers are not infallible.
2. It is obligatory for a leader to **establish justice** within the society.
3. **Truthfulness** should be the basis of all dealings between a leader and his people.
4. **Jihad didn't end** with the death of the Prophet ﷺ.
5. A strong nation is the one which is **productive** and it is **not preoccupied with desires and lusts**.

Ali's Pledge & the Issue of Fadak:

1. There are **three views** regarding the pledge of allegiance of Ali:
 - a. He gave the pledge at the **general pledge** of allegiance.
 - b. He gave the pledge **after six months**.
 - c. He gave the pledge **initially and then reaffirmed** it after six months.
2. The pledge of Ali is closely associated with the **distribution of inheritance** of the Prophet ﷺ which will be discussed side by side.
3. The **best opinion** is the third one that Ali gave the pledge initially but had something in his heart which he later expressed after the death of Fatimah (after six months of the first pledge).

Following are the narrations which support this fact:

- a. *Narrated by Ayesha.....During the lifetime of Fatima, 'Ali received (special) regard from the people. After she had died, he felt estrangement in the faces of the people towards him. So he sought to make peace with Abu Bakr and offer his allegiance to him. **He had not yet owed allegiance to him as Caliph during these months**. He sent a person to Abu Bakr requesting him to visit him unaccompanied by anyone (disapproving the presence of Umar). 'Umar said to Abu Bakr: **By Allah, you will not visit them (Banu Hashim) alone**. Abu Bakr said: **What will they do to me? By Allah, I will visit them. And he did pay them a visit alone**. 'Ali recited Tashahhud (as it is done in the beginning of a religious sermon) ; then said: **We recognise your moral excellence and what Allah has bestowed upon you. We do not envy the favour (i. e. the Caliphate) which Allah has conferred upon you; but you have done it (assumed the position of Caliph) alone (without consulting us), and we thought we had a right (to this Caliphate) on account of our kinship with the Messenger of Allah (ﷺ)**. He continued to talk to Abu Bakr (in this vein) until the latter's eyes welled up with tears. Then Abu Bakr spoke and said: **By Allah, in Whose Hand is my life, the kinship of the Messenger of Allah (ﷺ) is dearer to me than the kinship of my own people. As regards the dispute that has arisen between you and me about these properties (Fadak etc), I have not deviated from the right course and I have not given up doing about them what the Messenger of Allah (ﷺ) used to do**. So 'Ali said to Abu Bakr: **This afternoon is (fixed) for (swearing) allegiance (to you)**. So when Abu Bakr had finished his Zuhr prayer, he ascended the pulpit and recited Tashahhud, and described the status of 'Ali, his delay in swearing allegiance and*

the excuse which he had offered to him (for this delay). (After this) he asked for God's forgiveness. Then 'Ali b. Abu Talib recited the Tashahhud. extolled the merits of Abu Bakr and (said that) his action was not prompted by any jealousy of Abu Bakr on his part or his refusal to accept the high position which Allah had conferred upon him, (adding:) **But we were of the opinion that we should have a share in the government, but the matter had been decided without taking us into confidence, and this displeased us.** (Hence the delay in offering allegiance. The Muslims were pleased with this (explanation) and they said: **You have done the right thing.** The Muslims were (again) favourably inclined to 'Ali since he adopted the proper course of action.

(Muslim: 1759)

- b. Abu Bakr sat down on the pulpit and saw that Ali (may Allah be pleased with him) was not among the people. He asked, **"Where is he?"** They called him, and when he came, Abu Bakr (may Allah be pleased with him) said, **"You are the son of the Prophet's uncle and his son-in-law. My intention is to hand over the reins of the Muslims to you."** Ali (may Allah be pleased with him) said, **"There is no harm in it,"** and Ali pledged allegiance to him. Then he saw Zubair bin Awwam, who was not in sight. He asked about him, and they called him. He said the same thing that Ali had said, and both of them pledged allegiance to Abu Bakr.

(Sunan al-Kubra- Imam al-Bayhaqi: 16538)

4. As for the issue of Fadak (a lot of Khayber which the Prophet ﷺ got after the battle of Khayber), the issue raised as the heirs of Prophet ﷺ thought they had the right to the inheritance of the Prophet ﷺ.
 - a. According to the Sunni Muslims, if the **property of the Prophet ﷺ had to be distributed**, it would be distributed between:
 - i. All **9 wives** of the Prophet ﷺ who were alive at the time of his ﷺ death,
 - ii. **Abbas** bin Abdul Muttalib, and
 - iii. **Fatimah**.
5. As for the wives, they thought about **sending Uthman bin Affan to Abu Bakr** to ask him about their share and this is what happened:

a. Narrated `Urwa:

`Aisha said, "When Allah's Messenger (ﷺ) died, his wives intended to send `Uthman to Abu Bakr asking him for their share of the inheritance." Then `Aisha said to them, "Didn't Allah's Messenger (ﷺ) say, 'Our (Apostles') property is not to be inherited, and whatever we leave is to be spent in charity?"

(Bukhari: 6730)

6. As for **Fatimah**, we have the following narrations:
 - a. It is narrated on the authority of Urwa b. Zubair who narrated from A'isha that she informed him that Fatima, daughter of the Messenger of Allah (ﷺ), **sent someone to Abu Bakr to demand from him her share of the legacy left by the Messenger of Allah (ﷺ) from what Allah had bestowed upon him at Medina and Fadak and what was left from one-fifth of the income (annually received) from Khaibar.** Abu Bakr said:

The Messenger of Allah (ﷺ) said: "**We (prophets) do not have any heirs; what we leave behind is (to be given in) charity.**" The household of the Messenger of Allah (ﷺ) will **live on the income from these properties**, but, by Allah, I will not change the charity of the Messenger of Allah (ﷺ) from the condition in which it was in his own time. I will do the same with it as the Messenger of Allah (may peace be upon him) himself used to do. So Abu Bakr refused to hand over anything from it to Fatima who **got angry with Abu Bakr** for this reason. **She forsook him and did not talk to him until the end of her life.** She lived for six months after the death of the Messenger of Allah (ﷺ). When she died, her husband, **'Ali b. Abu Talib, buried her at night.** He did not inform Abu Bakr about her death and offered the funeral prayer over her himself...

(Muslim: 1759a)

- b. Narrated `Aisha: (mother of the believers) After the death of Allah's Apostle Fatima the daughter of Allah's Messenger (ﷺ) asked Abu Bakr As-Siddiq to give her, her share of inheritance from what Allah's Messenger (ﷺ) had left of the Fai (i.e. booty gained without fighting) which Allah had given him. Abu Bakr said to her, **"Allah's Apostle said, 'Our property will not be inherited, whatever we (i.e. prophets) leave is Sadaqa (to be used for charity).'"** Fatima, the daughter of Allah's Messenger (ﷺ) got angry and stopped speaking to Abu Bakr, and **continued assuming that attitude till she died.** Fatima remained alive for six months after the death of Allah's Messenger (ﷺ). She used to ask Abu Bakr for her share from the property of Allah's Messenger (ﷺ) which he left at Khaibar, and Fadak, and his property at Medina (devoted for charity). Abu Bakr refused to give her that property and said, **"I will not leave anything Allah's Messenger (ﷺ) used to do, because I am afraid that if I left something from the Prophet's ﷺ tradition, then I would go astray."** (Later on) `Umar gave the Prophet's property (of Sadaqa) at Medina to `Ali and `Abbas (to manage), but he withheld the properties of Khaibar and Fadak in his custody and said, **"These two properties are the Sadaqa which Allah's Apostle used to use for his expenditures and urgent needs. Now their management is to be entrusted to the ruler."** (Az-Zuhri said, "They have been managed in this way till today.")

(Bukhari: 3092-3093)

- c. Shabi says: When Fatima (may Allah be pleased with her) became ill, Abu Bakr (may Allah be pleased with him) came to her. He asked for permission [to enter]. Ali (may Allah be pleased with him) said, **"O Fatima! Abu Bakr has come and is asking permission to come to you."** Fatima said, **"Do you like that I give permission?"** Ali (may Allah be pleased with him) said, **"Yes."** So Fatima gave permission. He came to Fatima, appeased her, and said, **"I did not abandon home, wealth, family, and relatives except for the pleasure of Allah, the pleasure of the Messenger (peace and blessings of Allah be upon him), and your pleasure, O people of the house."** Then he appeased her, and she was pleased.

(Sunan al-Kubra Bayhaqi: 12735)